```
        }

        // Check if the authenticated user has the required role

        $user = Auth::user();

        if ($user->role !== $role) {

            abort(403, 'Unauthorized action.');

        }

        return $next($request);

    }

}
```

Here, the middleware ensures that only users whose **role** attribute matches the specified role can proceed. You can expand this logic to accept multiple roles if needed, by checking if the user's role exists in an array of permitted roles.